

I did something well for years that turned out to be harmful.

My team was visible. Prioritized. Well-resourced. I made sure of it — taking the stakeholder meetings, building the relationships, marketing what we built. The team produced. I made sure people noticed.

When I got promoted, I learned what I had actually created: a team that could not make itself visible without me. Nobody knew how to advocate for the work. Nobody had the relationships. I had been so good at protecting them from that part of the job that they had never learned it.

If you are irreplaceable to your team, you are also not promotable.

That is not just a career truth. It is a team truth.

What does it cost your people when you eventually leave the role?

#leadership #management #teamwork #careergrowth